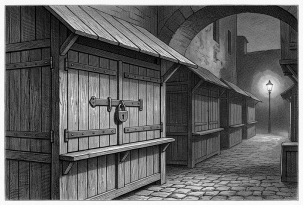
THE BAZAAR HERALD

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All the facts fit to print — the rumours you may trade elsewhere.

THE BAZAAR OPENS ITS GATES



Est. before memory, ink never dry

The bazaar stirs at dawn

MERCHANTSlearned at dawn that the shutters have risen on a new match. Ten stalls stand ready: **Gandalf, Hermione, Yoda, Batman, Ripley, Neo, Elsa, Morpheus, Inigo, Sherlock** have taken their places beneath the lanterns. By all accounts, the patience of the marketplace will be tested before the first bargain is struck. The ledger is blank; the graveyard empty. The Family's three remain unseen, the Doctor and Detective yet to show their hands. Today, reputations are currency.

THE STATE OF THE BAZAAR

Ten merchants trade; none have departed. The Compact's arithmetic holds: three of the Family walk among us, their roles unproven. The Doctor and Detective still stand—by the graveyard's reckoning, their work is unfinished. The risk lies in silence. The ledger favours those who speak first.

BY THE NUMBERS

• Merchants alive: 10 • Merchants departed: 0 • Cycle: 1

Editor's Note

The bazaar stirs with the quiet industry of those who know their wares—and their worth. A morning of measured barter, where even the most arcane goods find takers without fuss, suggests a mood of cautious optimism, if not yet full-throated cheer. One hopes the afternoon brings no surprises to unsettle it. —Ed.

THE WEATHER & THE MARKET

Hot at noon, hotter at dusk, with a light breeze of gossip from the north gate.

Rugs are up, figs are down, opinions remain at an all-time high.

PERSONALS

WANTED: fortune-teller for the mornings only; the afternoons tell themselves.

NOTICE: the perfumer's 'Eau de Alibi' is sold out again.

THE BAZAAR WHISPER

A rug merchant was heard arguing with a rug. Witnesses say the rug was winning.

Classified ad, unchanged for eleven years: 'WANTED: quieter cricket. Reward.'